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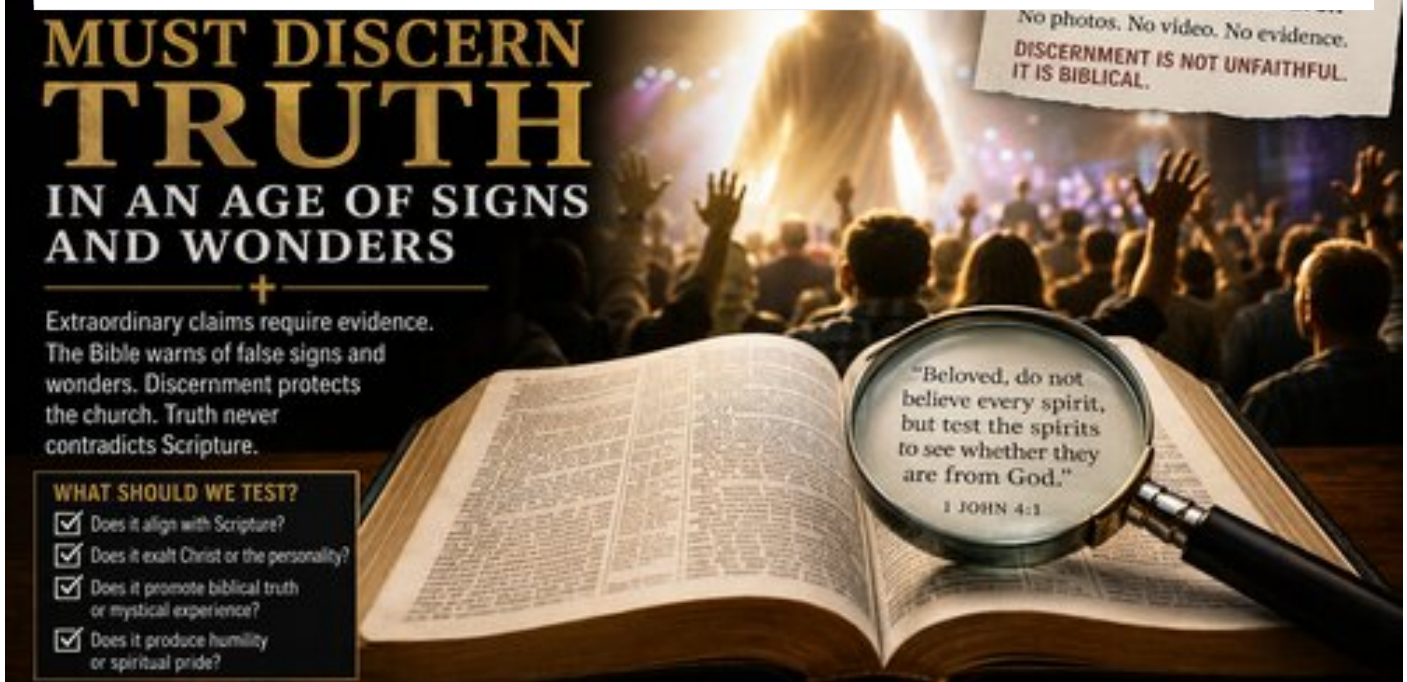
ARTICLE

Test Everything: Discern Truth In An Age Of Signs And Wonders



True Repentance = True Freedom - Repentance Leads to Freedom

God's love can transform your life today. Here's how. Peace With God



BY PNW STAFF JUNE 16, 2026

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One of the greatest challenges facing the modern church is not atheism, secularism, or even persecution. It is discernment.

In an age where anyone can create a ministry, declare themselves an apostle, post a testimony online, and instantly gain thousands of followers, Christians are increasingly being asked to accept extraordinary claims with little or no evidence. Too often, many do exactly that.

True Repentance = True Freedom

Pray This Simple Prayer Today

Do you want to be forgiven? Pray this simple repentance prayer & experience true peace.

Peace With God

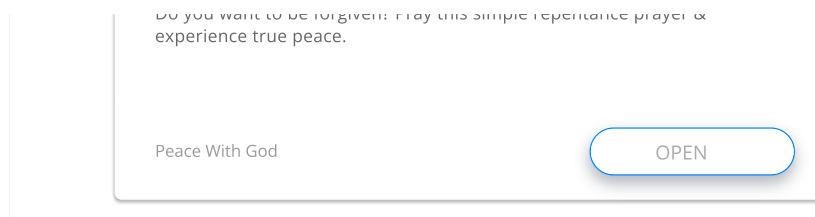
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A recent example comes from Australia, where self-styled apostle David Vaka claimed that Jesus physically appeared during a Pentecost service on the Sunshine Coast. According to Vaka, "The King of Glory Himself turned up in person." He described seeing Jesus wearing a massive crown and moving through the room, personally crowning attendees with kingly authority and power.

Vaka further stated that he had previously witnessed angels appearing and ministering to people, but this was the first time he had seen Jesus descend in such a manner. He also claimed God spoke through him to the city's mayor regarding a vision to transform the Sunshine Coast into a "Kingdom City."

Yet despite the magnitude of these claims, no photographs, video footage, independent eyewitness documentation, or verifiable evidence has been presented.

That fact alone should not necessarily cause Christians to mock or dismiss the story outright. God is capable of anything. The Bible records numerous supernatural encounters. The God who parted the Red Sea, raised Lazarus, and appeared to Saul on the road to Damascus certainly possesses the power to reveal Himself however He chooses.



The issue is not whether God can do such things.

The issue is whether Christians are obeying Scripture's command to test such claims.

The Apostle John warned believers, "Beloved, do not believe every spirit, but test the spirits to see whether they are from God" (1 John 4:1). Notice that John does not tell Christians to automatically believe spiritual claims. Nor does he tell them to automatically reject them. He tells them to test them.

That command is more important today than ever.

The modern church often swings between two extremes. Some believers reject anything supernatural and become practical skeptics. Others accept nearly every miracle story, prophetic word, angelic visitation, heavenly encounter, or apostolic declaration without asking a single question.

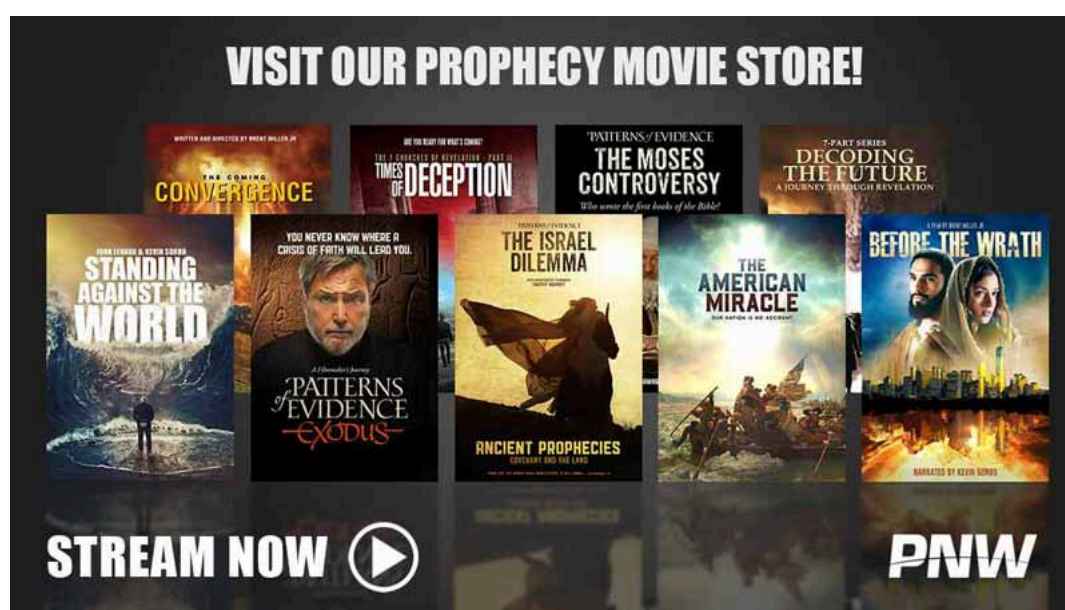
Neither approach is biblical.

Discernment requires examination.

Throughout Scripture, signs and wonders alone were never considered sufficient proof that someone spoke for God. In fact, the Bible repeatedly warns that false signs and wonders will accompany deception.

Jesus Himself warned that false christs and false prophets would arise and perform "great signs and wonders" capable of deceiving many if possible (Matthew 24:24).

Paul warned that the coming of the lawless one would be accompanied by "all power and false signs and wonders" (2 Thessalonians 2:9).



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The book of Revelation describes miraculous displays that persuade entire populations to follow a counterfeit religious system.

In other words, supernatural activity by itself is not proof of divine approval.

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Yet the Bible never instructs believers to trust a man because he calls himself an apostle, prophet, pastor, or evangelist.

We are told to examine the message.

Does it align with Scripture?

Does it point people toward Christ or toward the personality making the claim?

Does it exalt God's Word or elevate mystical experiences?

Does it encourage biblical humility or create spiritual elitism?

These questions matter because deception rarely arrives wearing a name tag that says "False Teacher." It usually comes wrapped in Christian language, accompanied by spiritual excitement, and promoted by people who appear sincere.

Perhaps one of the most concerning aspects of modern Christianity is how quickly many believers are captivated by experiences while neglecting biblical knowledge.

The Bereans in Acts 17 provide the opposite example. Even when listening to the Apostle Paul himself, they searched the Scriptures daily to verify whether what he taught was true.

Think about that.

They tested the words of an actual apostle.

Today many Christians refuse to test the words of self-appointed apostles.

The result is confusion, division, and vulnerability to deception.

As the world moves closer to the prophetic events described in Scripture, discernment will become increasingly important. Jesus repeatedly warned believers not to be deceived. That warning appears again and again because deception will become one of the defining characteristics of the last days.

Christians should remain open to God's supernatural power. We should believe He still works miracles. We should never place God inside a theological box.

But neither should we abandon discernment.

Every testimony should be tested.

Every prophecy should be examined.



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And not an experience, a vision, a miracle claim, or a self-proclaimed apostle.

It is the unchanging Word of God.

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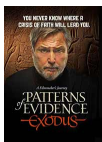
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